



Podcast Platform

USER MANUAL

Complete Guide to All Features & Functions

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Graduation Project — Computer Science Department

React / Vite Web Application

CONFIDENTIAL | For Academic Evaluation Purposes

Table of Contents

1	Introduction	
1.1	What is SonicAI?	
1.2	Key Features at a Glance	
2	System Requirements	
2.1	Supported Devices & Browsers	
2.2	Internet & Account Requirements	
3	User Registration	
3.1	Registration Process Flow	
3.2	Step-by-Step Instructions	
3.3	Common Registration Errors	
4	User Login	
4.1	Login Process Flow	
4.2	How to Log In & Log Out	
5	Browsing Podcasts	
5.1	Homepage Layout	
5.2	Navigation & Podcast Cards	
6	Searching Podcasts	
6.1	Search Flow Diagram	

6.2	Search Features & Tips	
7	Playing Episodes	
7.1	Playback Flow Diagram	
7.2	Audio Player Controls	
8	Managing Favorites	
8.1	Favorites Flow Diagram	
8.2	Add, View & Remove Favorites	
9	AI Recommendations	
9.1	AI Summarization Feature	
9.2	How to Generate a Summary	
10	Analytics Dashboard	
10.1	Analytics Flow Diagram	
10.2	Dashboard Widgets & Statistics	
11	Listening History	
12	Statistics & Insights	
13	Troubleshooting	
13.1 –13.7	Issue Categories & Solutions	
13.8	Keyboard Shortcuts	

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Welcome to the **SonicAI Podcast Platform** — your intelligent companion for discovering, listening to, and enjoying podcasts from around the world. This manual provides comprehensive guidance for all platform features and is designed for users of all technical levels.

1.1 What is SonicAI?

SonicAI is a modern web-based podcast platform built with React and Vite that helps you discover thousands of podcasts across various categories, listen directly in your browser, track listening history, and obtain AI-powered episode summaries via Google Gemini.

1.2 Key Features at a Glance

Feature	Description
Browse & Discover	Explore podcasts by category, trending, or curated collections
Smart Search	Find podcasts by title, publisher, or topic
Audio Player	Play episodes with play/pause, progress tracking, and volume control
Favorites	Save and organize your favourite podcasts
AI Summaries	Get instant AI-generated summaries of any episode
Analytics Dashboard	View your listening statistics and personalized insights
Dark / Light Mode	Choose your preferred visual theme
Responsive Design	Works on desktop, tablet, and mobile devices

Table 1.1 — Key Features of SonicAI Podcast Platform

CHAPTER 2

System Requirements

Before using SonicAI, ensure your device and browser meet the minimum requirements below.

2.1 Supported Devices & Browsers

Device Type	Supported?	Notes
Desktop / Laptop	✓ Yes	Windows, macOS, or Linux
Tablet (iPad, Android)	✓ Yes	Works in landscape or portrait mode
Smartphone	✓ Yes	Optimised for mobile browsing

Table 2.1 — Supported Device Types

Browser	Min. Version	Recommended?
Google Chrome	90+	★ Highly Recommended
Mozilla Firefox	88+	✓ Yes
Apple Safari	14+	✓ Yes
Microsoft Edge	90+	✓ Yes
Opera	76+	✓ Yes
Internet Explorer	—	✗ Not Supported

Table 2.2 — Supported Web Browsers

■ **Note:** Internet Explorer is not supported. Please use a modern browser for the best experience.

2.2 Internet & Account Requirements

Activity	Minimum Speed	Recommended Speed
Browsing & Search	1 Mbps	3+ Mbps
Playing Audio	128 Kbps	256+ Kbps
AI Summaries	1 Mbps	3+ Mbps

Table 2.3 — Internet Speed Requirements

Feature	Account Required?
Browse & Search Podcasts	No — Guest Mode available

Feature	Account Required?
Play Episodes	No — Guest Mode available
Save Favorites	Yes — Free Registration
View Analytics Dashboard	Yes — Free Registration
AI Summaries	Yes — Free Registration

Table 2.4 — Account Requirements by Feature

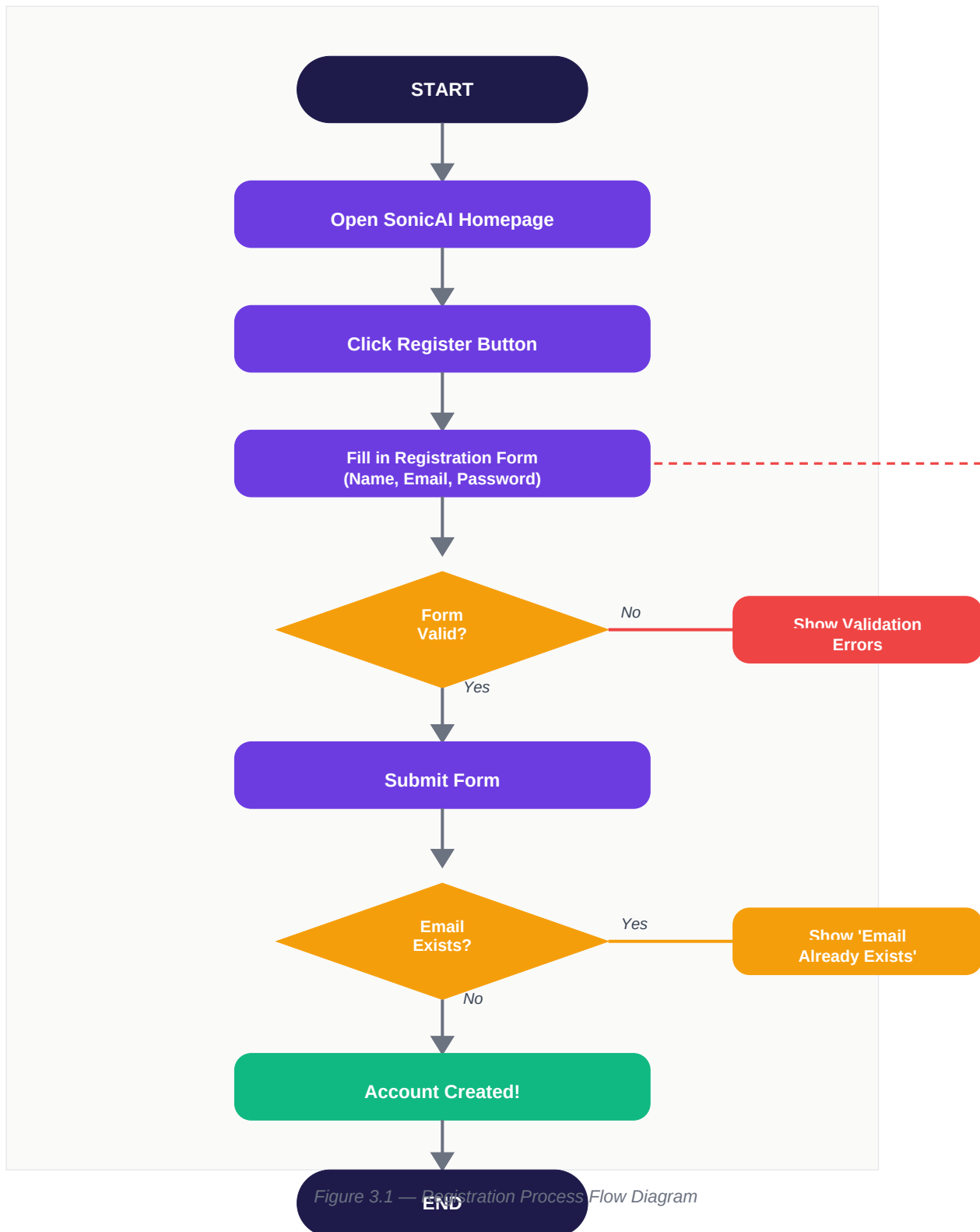
CHAPTER 3

User Registration

Creating a SonicAI account is quick, free, and unlocks all platform features including Favorites, Analytics, and AI Summaries.

3.1 Registration Process Flow

The diagram below illustrates the complete registration workflow from start to finish.



3.2 Step-by-Step Registration Instructions

- 1 Open your web browser and navigate to the SonicAI Podcast Platform homepage.

- 2 Click the "Register" button in the top-right corner of the navigation bar.
- 3 Complete the registration form with the required information (see Table 3.1).
- 4 Click the "Create Account" button to submit the form.
- 5 A success message confirms account creation and you are automatically logged in.

Field	Required?	Description	Example
Full Name	✓ Yes	Your display name on the platform	John Smith
Email Address	✓ Yes	A valid email for account access	john@example.com
Phone Number	Optional	Contact number (not required)	+1 555-123-4567
Password	✓ Yes	Minimum 6 characters	
Confirm Password	✓ Yes	Must match the password above	

Table 3.1 — Registration Form Fields

✓ **Tip:** Use a real email address. Choose a strong password with letters, numbers, and symbols.

3.3 Common Registration Errors

Error Message	What It Means	How to Fix
"Email already exists"	This email is already registered	Use a different email or click "Login"
"Passwords do not match"	The two password fields differ	Re-type both password fields carefully
"Fill in all required fields"	A required field is empty	Complete all fields marked as required

Table 3.2 — Common Registration Errors and Solutions

CHAPTER 4

User Login

If you already have a SonicAI account, use the Login feature to access all your personalised content.

4.1 Login Process Flow

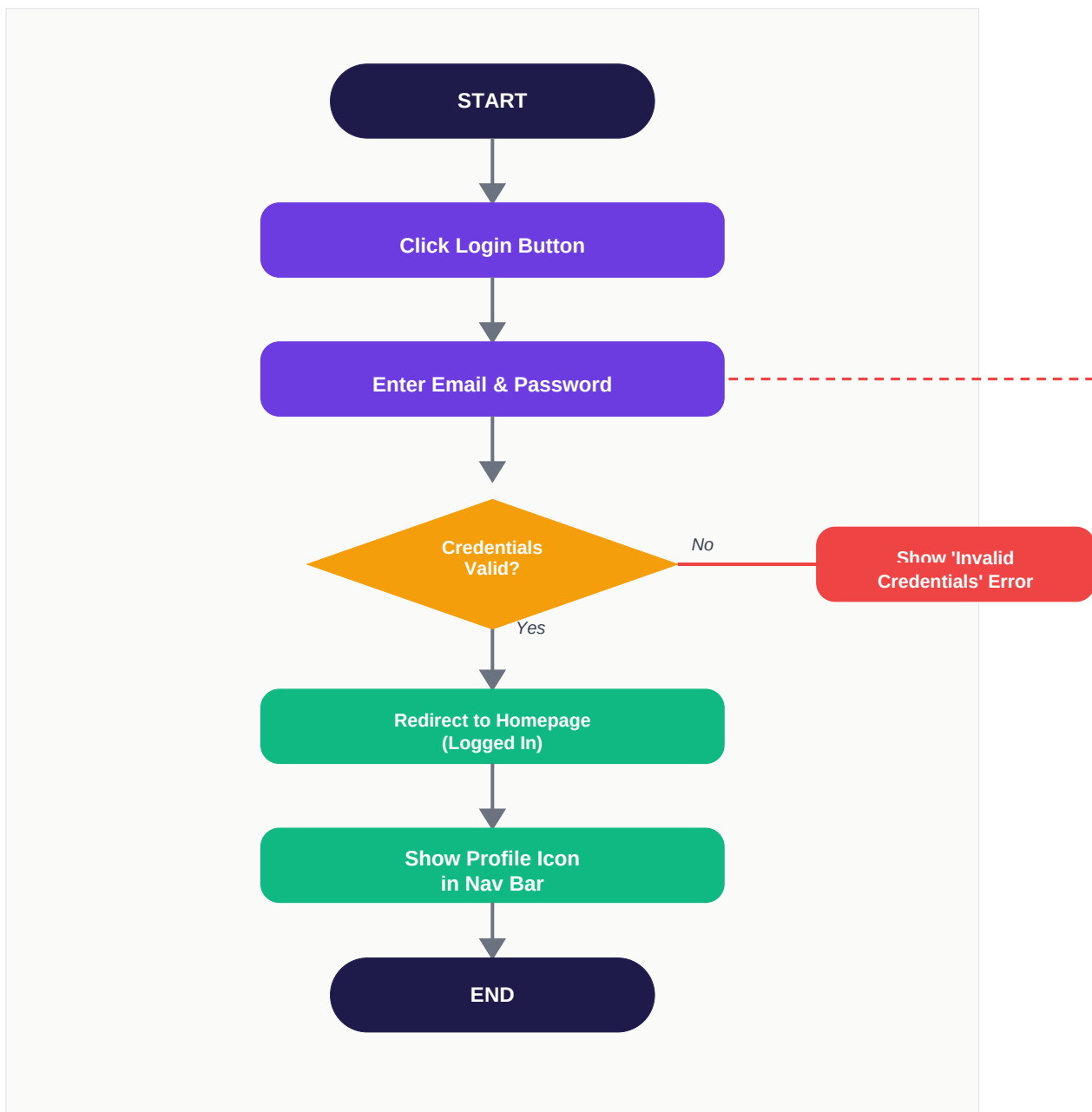


Figure 4.1 — Login Process Flow Diagram

4.2 How to Log In

- 1 Click the "Login" button in the top-right corner of the homepage.
- 2 Enter your registered Email Address and Password.
- 3 (Optional) Check "Remember me" to stay logged in on this device.
- 4 Click the "Login" button to proceed.
- 5 On success, you will be redirected to the homepage with your profile icon visible.

✓ **Tip:** After logging in, the Login / Register buttons are replaced by your profile icon.

4.3 How to Log Out

- 1 Click your profile icon or name in the top-right navigation bar.
- 2 Select "Logout" from the dropdown menu.

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
"Invalid email or password"	Wrong credentials entered	Check email & password (case-sensitive)
"Email already exists"	Account already registered	Click Login instead of Register
Logged out unexpectedly	Browser cleared local data	Log in again and check Remember Me
Forgotten password	No email recovery system	Create a new account with a different email

Table 4.1 — Login Issues and Solutions

■ **Warning:** There is currently no email-based password recovery. Store your password securely.

CHAPTER 5

Browsing Podcasts

The SonicAI homepage is your gateway to discovering podcasts. Use the sidebar navigation to explore different sections of the platform.

5.1 Navigation Sidebar

Icon	Section	Description
■	Home	Return to the main homepage
■	Explore	Browse all podcasts with filters
■	Trending	See the most popular podcasts right now
■	Categories	Browse by topic — Tech, Comedy, Business, etc.
♥■	Favorites	View your saved podcasts (Login required)
■	Dashboard	View analytics and insights (Login required)

Table 5.1 — Sidebar Navigation Sections

5.2 Podcast Cards

Each podcast is displayed as a visual card. Hover over a card to reveal the Play button and Favorite (heart) icon.

Card Element	What It Shows
Cover Image	Podcast artwork; hover reveals Play and Heart buttons
Category Badge	Genre label (e.g., Technology, Comedy)
Title	Name of the podcast
Publisher	Creator / production company
Description	Short excerpt of the podcast description
Episode Count	Total number of episodes available
Rating	Average listener rating (if available)

Table 5.2 — Podcast Card Elements

5.3 Browsing by Category

- 1 Click "Categories" in the left sidebar.

2 A grid of category cards is displayed (Arts, Business, Comedy, Technology, etc.).

3 Click any category to filter and view podcasts in that genre.

✓ **Tip:** Trending podcasts are updated regularly based on listening activity across the platform.

CHAPTER 6

Searching Podcasts

The search feature allows you to find podcasts by title, publisher name, or topic keywords. It supports real-time querying and category filtering.

6.1 Podcast Search Flow

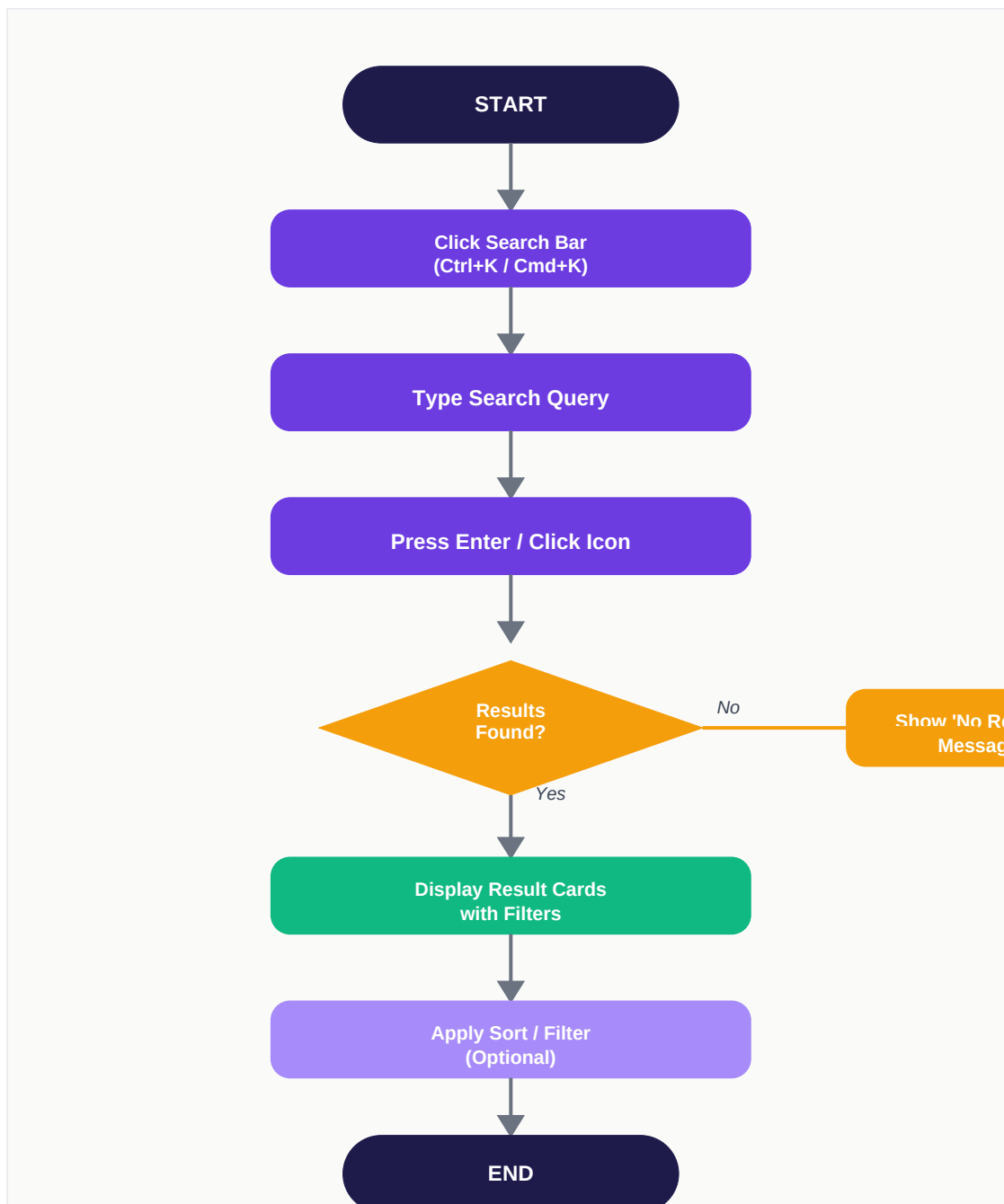


Figure 6.1 — Podcast Search Flow Diagram

6.2 How to Search

- 1 Click the search bar at the top of the page, or press Ctrl+K (Windows) / Cmd+K (Mac).
- 2 Type your query — podcast titles, publisher names, or topic keywords.
- 3 Press Enter or click the search icon to submit.
- 4 Browse the results grid; use Sort and Filter controls to refine.

Feature	How to Use
Sort Results	Click the Sort dropdown — choose Relevance, Rating, or Newest
Filter by Category	Use the Category filter to narrow results to a genre
Pagination	Click page numbers or Prev / Next to browse more results
Clear Search	Click the X in the search bar to clear and start over

Table 6.1 — Search Results Features

✓ **Tip:** Use specific keywords for better results (e.g., "python programming" not just "programming").

CHAPTER 7

Playing Episodes

SonicAI includes a built-in audio player that lets you listen to podcast episodes directly in your browser without any downloads.

7.1 Podcast Playback Flow

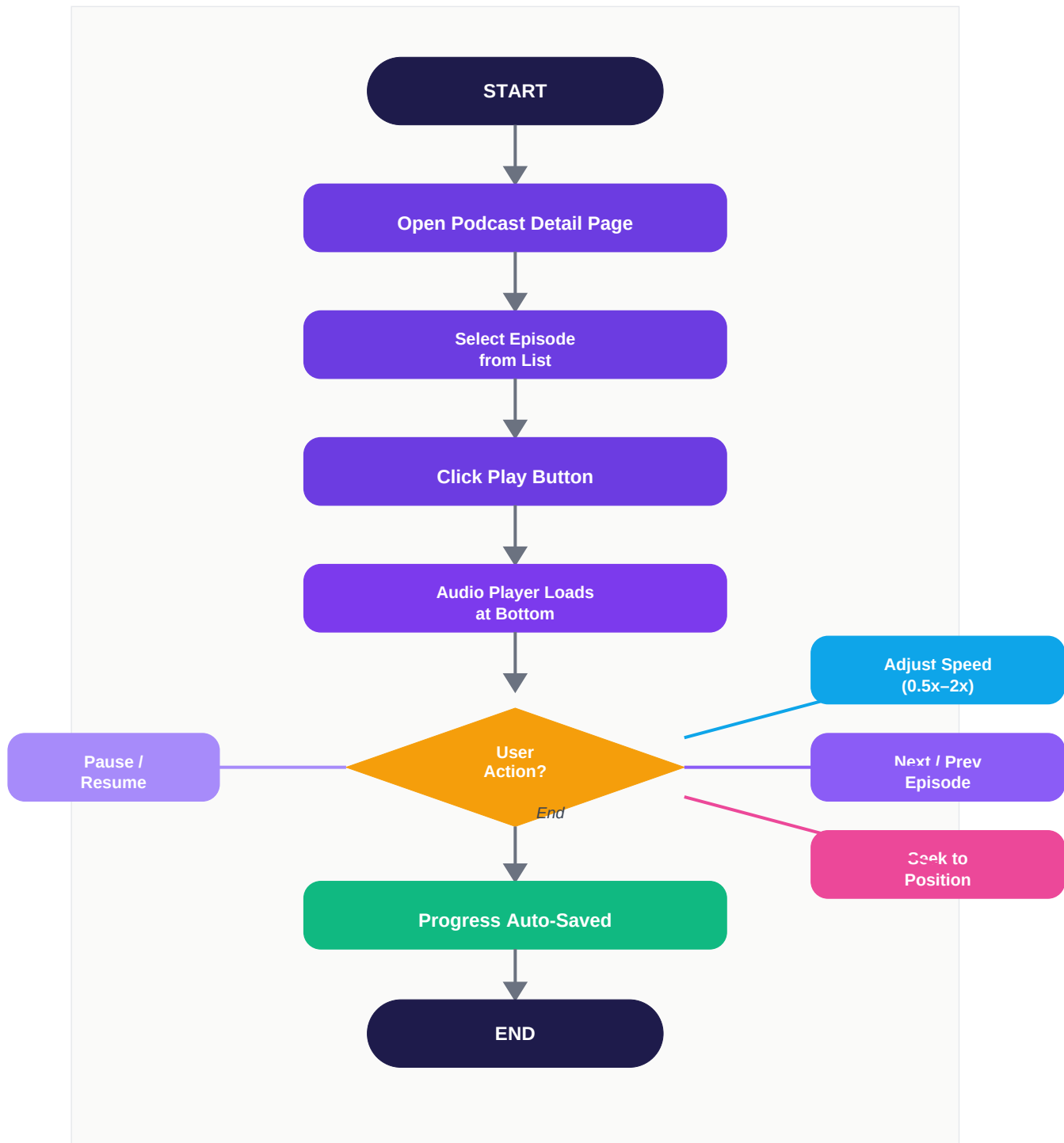


Figure 7.1 — Podcast Playback Flow Diagram

7.2 How to Play an Episode

1 Navigate to a podcast's detail page by clicking on any podcast card.

2 Scroll down to the Episodes list.

3 Click the Play button next to any episode.

4 The audio player bar appears at the bottom of the screen.

Control	Action	Description
■ Previous	Skip Back	Jump to the previous episode in the list
■/■ Play/Pause	Toggle	Start or pause audio playback
■ Next	Skip Forward	Move to the next episode
Progress Bar	Seek	Click or drag to jump to any position in the episode
■ Volume	Adjust	Control the speaker volume level
■ Speed	Playback Rate	Switch between 0.5×, 1×, 1.5×, and 2× speed

Table 7.1 — Audio Player Controls

7.3 Playback Speed Options

Speed	Use Case
0.5×	Slow listening — great for complex topics or note-taking
1×	Normal speed (default)
1.5×	Faster listening — save time without losing comprehension
2×	Double speed — ideal for quick review or familiar content

Table 7.2 — Playback Speed Options

✓ **Tip:** The player remembers your progress. Pausing and returning resumes from the same position.

CHAPTER 8

Managing Favorites

Your Favorites list is a personal collection of saved podcasts. Add, remove, and manage your favorites from any podcast card or detail page.

8.1 Favorites Flow

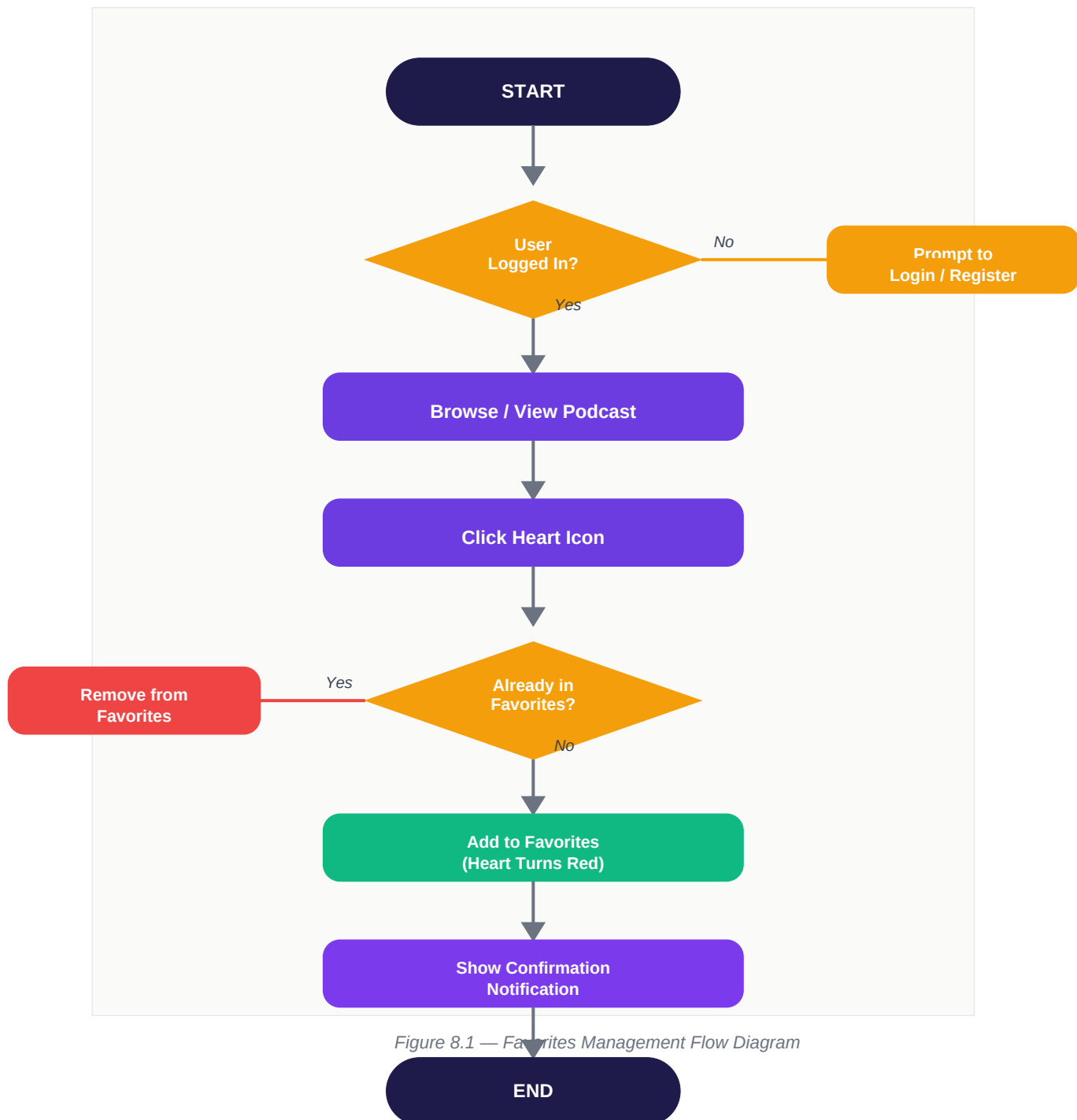


Figure 8.1 — Favorites Management Flow Diagram

8.2 How to Add a Podcast to Favorites

Method 1 — From a Podcast Card:

- 1 Find a podcast while browsing the homepage or search results.
- 2 Hover over the podcast card to reveal the heart icon.
- 3 Click the heart icon — it turns solid red and a notification confirms the action.

Method 2 — From the Podcast Detail Page:

- 1 Open any podcast detail page.
- 2 Click the "Add to Favorites" button near the top of the page.

■ **Note:** You must be logged in to use the Favorites feature.

8.3 Viewing and Managing Your Favorites

Action	How to Perform
View all favorites	Click "Favorites" in the left sidebar
Remove a single podcast	Click the filled heart on the card (toggles off)
Remove from Favorites page	Click the Remove button on any saved card
Clear all favorites	Click "Clear All Favorites" at the bottom of the Favorites page

Table 8.1 — Favorites Management Actions

■ **Warning:** Clearing all favorites is permanent and cannot be undone.

CHAPTER 9

AI Recommendations

SonicAI integrates Google Gemini AI to generate intelligent episode summaries, helping you decide what to listen to before committing your time.

9.1 What is AI Summarization?

The AI analyses the podcast title, publisher, description, and episode details to produce a structured summary with three components:

Summary Component	Description
Overview	A concise summary of the episode's main topic and content
Key Points	The most important takeaways and insights from the episode
Target Audience	Who will most benefit from or enjoy this episode

Table 9.1 — AI Summary Components

9.2 How to Generate an AI Summary

- 1 Navigate to a Podcast Details or Episode Details page.
- 2 Locate the AI Summary section or the "Summarize" button next to an episode.
- 3 Click the "Generate Summary" or robot icon button.
- 4 Wait 2–5 seconds while the AI analyses the content.
- 5 The structured summary appears with Overview, Key Points, and Target Audience.

✓ **Tip:** You can regenerate a summary at any time to receive a fresh analysis.

■ **Note:** AI Summarization requires a logged-in account.

■ **Warning:** If the AI is temporarily unavailable, you will see: "Free AI limit reached — wait 10 seconds and retry."

CHAPTER 10

Analytics Dashboard

The Analytics Dashboard provides a comprehensive overview of your podcast listening habits, statistics, and personalized recommendations.

10.1 Analytics Dashboard Flow

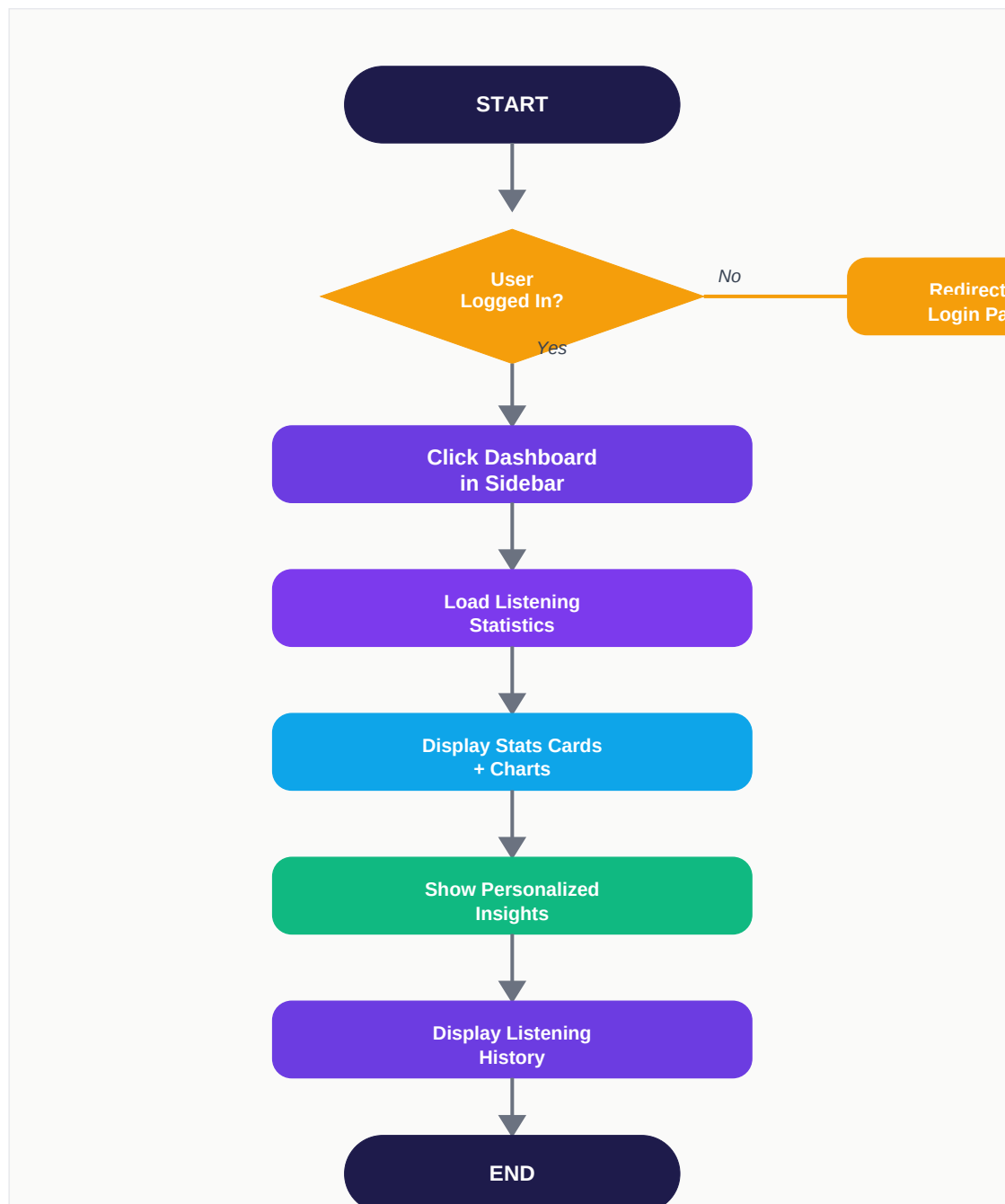


Figure 10.1 — Analytics Dashboard Access Flow Diagram

10.2 Dashboard Widgets

Once inside the Dashboard, you will see the following information widgets:

Widget	What It Shows
Total Listening Time	Cumulative hours and minutes of audio playback
Total Episodes Played	Number of distinct episodes started
Favourite Genre	The category you listen to most frequently
Active Streak	Number of consecutive days with at least one listen
Listening Activity Chart	Bar chart showing listening time per day of the week
Top Categories Chart	Pie chart showing percentage breakdown by genre
Recently Played	Chronological list of your most recent episodes

Table 10.1 — Analytics Dashboard Widgets

✓ **Tip:** Your dashboard updates in real-time as you listen. Check your streak to stay motivated!

CHAPTER 11

Viewing Listening History

Your Listening History tracks every episode you have played so you can easily revisit or resume content.

11.1 How to View Your History

- 1 Go to your Dashboard (see Chapter 10).
- 2 Scroll down to the "Recently Played" or "Listening History" section.

Column	Description
Episode Title	Name of the specific episode
Podcast Name	Which show the episode belongs to
Date Listened	When you last played this episode
Progress	Percentage of the episode you have listened to
Resume Button	Starts playback from your last saved position

Table 11.1 — Listening History Entry Details

11.2 Resuming an Episode

- 1 Find the episode in your Listening History list.
- 2 Click the Play button next to it.
- 3 Playback begins from your last saved position automatically.

✓ **Tip:** Your listening progress is saved automatically every few seconds during playback.

CHAPTER 12

Statistics & Insights

Beyond the basic dashboard, SonicAI provides deeper analytical insights into your listening patterns and behaviour over time.

12.1 Available Statistics

Statistic	Description	Location
Total Listening Time	Cumulative hours and minutes	Dashboard top card
Average Session Length	Typical duration per listening session	Dashboard
Peak Listening Hours	Time of day you listen most frequently	Insights section
Most Active Day	Day of week with highest listening activity	Insights section
Genre Distribution	Percentage breakdown by category	Pie chart
Completion Rate	Episodes finished vs. skipped or abandoned	Insights section
Discovery Rate	New podcasts tried over a time period	Insights section

Table 12.1 — Available Listening Statistics

12.2 Personalized Insights

SonicAI analyses your listening patterns and surfaces recommendations and behavioural insights to help you discover new content and track progress.

Insight Type	How It Helps You
Peak Listening Time	"You listen most on Tuesday evenings — explore new releases then!"
Genre Concentration	"80% of your listening is Technology — try Science or Business."
Listening Streak	"You're on a 5-day streak! Keep it up to reach your weekly goal."
Personalized Picks	Podcast recommendations based on your favorites and history

Table 12.2 — Types of Personalized Insights

CHAPTER 13

Troubleshooting

This chapter provides solutions to the most common issues encountered while using the SonicAI Podcast Platform.

13.1 Audio Playback Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
No sound	Volume is muted	Check the volume slider in the player bar and device volume
Audio won't play	Browser blocking autoplay	Click the Play button manually to start
Constant buffering	Slow internet connection	Pause and wait; check your connection speed
Player disappeared	Page was refreshed	Navigate back to the episode and click Play again

Table 13.1 — Audio Playback Issues

13.2 Login Issues

Refer to **Table 4.1** in Chapter 4 for a full list of login issues and solutions.

13.3 Search Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
No search results	Query too specific	Try broader keywords (e.g., "tech" not "quantum computing 2026")
Search is slow	Slow internet connection	Wait a moment and try again
Incorrect results	Typo in the query	Check your spelling and retype the query

Table 13.2 — Search Issues and Solutions

13.4 AI Summary Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
"AI limit reached"	Too many concurrent requests	Wait 10 seconds and try again
Summary is empty	API error occurred	Refresh the page and regenerate
Summarize button missing	User is not logged in	Log in to access AI features
Summary takes too long	Slow connection or high load	Wait up to 10 seconds; refresh if still loading

Table 13.3 — AI Summary Issues and Solutions

13.5 Favorites Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
Cannot add favorites	Not logged in	Log in to your account first
Favorites disappeared	Logged in with different account	Ensure you are using the same email
Heart button not visible	Guest / unauthenticated mode	Register or log in to see the favorite button

Table 13.4 — Favorites Issues and Solutions

13.6 Display Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
Page looks broken	Browser version too old	Update to the latest Chrome, Firefox, or Safari
Text is too small	Browser zoom level low	Press Ctrl + Plus (Win) or Cmd + Plus (Mac)
Dark mode not working	Cached page state	Refresh the page or clear browser cache
Images not loading	Slow internet connection	Wait for images; check your connection

Table 13.5 — Display Issues and Solutions

13.7 General Troubleshooting Tips

1. Refresh the page if anything seems stuck or not loading correctly.
2. Check your internet connection — most issues are caused by connectivity problems.
3. Clear browser cache (Ctrl+Shift+R or Cmd+Shift+R) if the site is not displaying correctly.
4. Use a supported browser (Chrome 90+, Firefox 88+, Safari 14+, Edge 90+).
5. Note the error message and steps that caused the issue when reporting a bug.

13.8 Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Space	Play / Pause audio
← Left Arrow	Rewind 10 seconds
→ Right Arrow	Fast-forward 10 seconds
↑ Up Arrow	Increase volume
↓ Down Arrow	Decrease volume
M	Mute / Unmute
Ctrl+K / Cmd+K	Open the search bar
Esc	Close search bar or modal dialogs

Table 13.6 — Keyboard Shortcuts

CHAPTER QR

Quick Reference Card

I want to...	How to do it
Create an account	Click Register → Fill in the form → Click Create Account
Log in	Click Login → Enter email + password → Click Login
Find a podcast	Use the Search bar or browse Categories in the sidebar
Listen to an episode	Click any podcast → Select an episode → Click Play
Save a podcast	Click the Heart icon on any podcast card (login required)
View saved podcasts	Click Favorites in the left sidebar
Get an AI summary	Open an episode → Click Summarize or robot icon
See my statistics	Click Dashboard in the left sidebar
Change theme	Click Profile icon → Toggle Theme
Log out	Click Profile icon → Logout

Table QR.1 — Quick Reference Guide

Support & Feedback

Email: adelalkady02@gmail.com
Feedback Form: Available in the footer of every page
Developer Documentation: Visit the Developer Docs for technical details

Thank you for using SonicAI Podcast Platform!
Happy Listening! ■

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